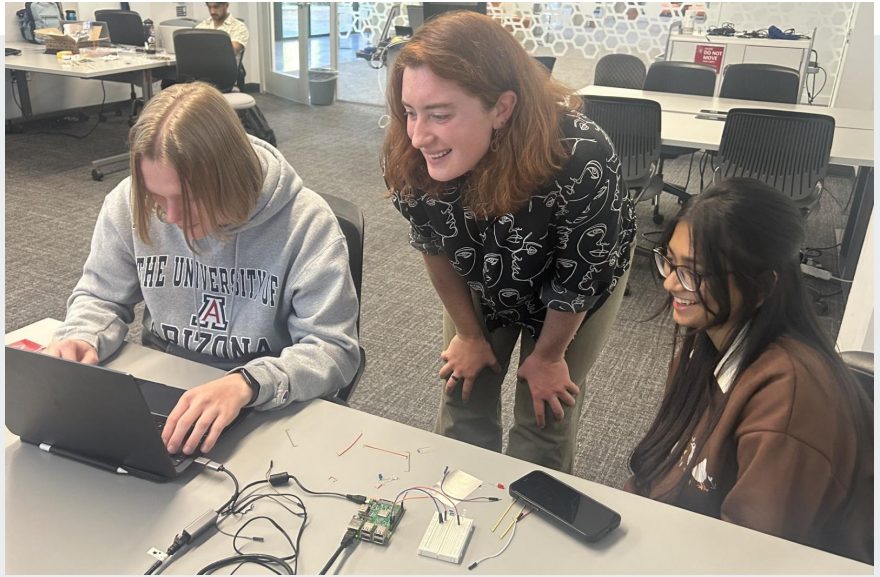
TIMESTEP



2026-27 Research Apprenticeship Program

Agenda

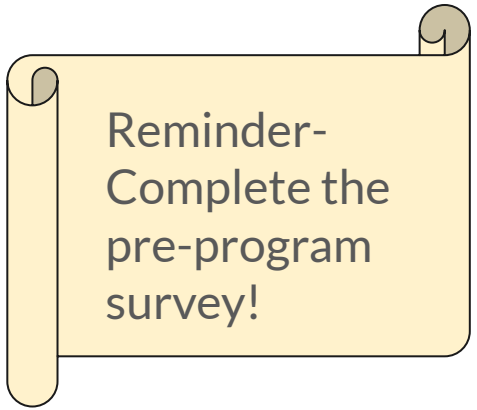
2:00 Welcome

2:05 2024-25 cohort short intros (1 min each- major(s), minor(s), where from, something unique)

2:30 Grad mentor intros- 1 min each

2:40 Program introduction

- Program format
- Time reporting, payroll, etc.
- Sanlyn introduction
- Mandatory reporter status



3:15 Breakout into grad mentor groups for rose, thorn, bud and to schedule individual meetings

3:30 End

Why this program?

NEED

- Few opportunities for students to engage in research in their first two years
- Little knowledge about various types of research
- Many technical skills not available in courses
- Students don't have a professional network
- Difficulty getting a foot in the door with no experience
- Financial instability

TIMESTEP Apprenticeship Program

- Students placed in research groups with a faculty or postdoc advisor
- Build computational and hardware/ software skills for research and internships
- Supportive, near-peer mentoring from graduate students
- Cohort model fosters connections and a sense of belonging
- Able to respond to changing needs and trends faster than revising curriculum
- Paid research opportunity for greater financial stability

TIMESTEP Apprenticeship Program

- Paid experience, August - May
- A skills-based apprenticeship for U of A students majoring in astronomy and/or physics
- Allows you to build technical and professional skills in a research environment
- Prepares you to be competitive for research programs (ex. NASA Space Grant Fellowship, UROC, REUs, etc.) and/or a paid position in TIMESTEP's Summer Tech Internship Program



Right: Student Kian Milani inspecting the vacuum space simulation chamber in the basement of Steward Observatory. Photo credit: Lori Harrison

Program format

ASTR 276

- Learn technical & professional skills

TIMESTEP workshops

- Mentoring support for navigating research demands
- Learn about research offerings at UA
- Cultivate community
- Get assistance working toward education and career goals

Research position

- Build knowledge of research area
- Utilize technical skills
- Complete a supported project/tasks
- Grow professional network

Graduate Student Mentors



Meredith Stone
Astrophysics



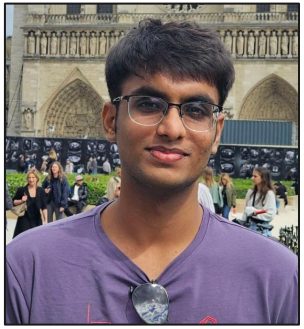
Brock Parker
Astrophysics



Brian Hsu
Astrophysics



Madi VanWyngarden
Astrophysics



Neev Shah
Astrophysics

- Teach technical skills in software and hardware
- Provide ongoing support throughout the program to ensure student success
- Assist students in navigating professional work spaces and demands
- Connect students to helpful resources

TIMESTEP Internship Symposium



Student Keynote Address by Nayera Abdessalam

- U of A astronomy and physics major
- Alumna of 1st cohort of the Astronomical Software Engineering Internship
- NASA Space Grant Intern
- 2026 summer intern at IBM

Thank you to the following supporters of the 2026 program:

TRBF THOMAS R. BROWN FOUNDATIONS

THE UNIVERSITY OF ARIZONA TECH LAUNCH ARIZONA

Space Institute

RESEARCH, INNOVATION & IMPACT Societal Impact

Physics

Astronomy & Steward Observatory

TIMESTEP

Wednesday, Sept. 2nd ✧ 5:00 to 7:15 pm

ENR2 building, Room S107

The 2026 cohort of TIMESTEP's Summer Tech Internships will be sharing their experiences in individual student presentations. Attendees have an opportunity to learn about local tech employers and the skills students need to be successful in industry and research positions.

Kindly RSVP here: